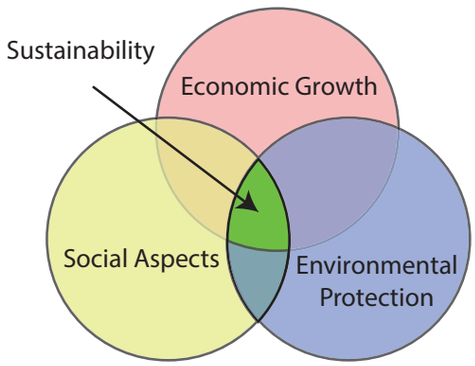
6.6 Sustainable Development

In 1987, the **Brundtland Commission** cited the definition of sustainability.

"Sustainable development is development that meets the needs of the present without compromising the ability of future generation to meet their own needs".

For sustainable development to be achieved, it is crucial to harmonize three core elements: **economic growth, social aspects and environmental protection**. These elements are interconnected and are crucial for the well-being of individuals and societies. To achieve true sustainability, we need to balance the economic ,social and environmental factors of sustainability in equal harmony.



Social Sustainability

The ability of a social system such as a country, family or organization to function at a defined level of social well being and harmony is called social sustainability. Problems like war, endemic poverty, widespread injustice and low education rates are symptoms of a system in socially unsustainable. The balancing capacity of a government in maintaining peaceful existence towards other countries and at the same time providing the requirements of its citizens without affecting the environment creates social sustainability.

Economic Sustainability

The people on earth consume far more than what is their fair share.

- The economic sustainability is successfully implemented through strong Public Distrubution System.
- Economic sustainability ensures that our economic growth maintains a healthy balance with our ecosystem.

Environmental Sustainability

Environmental sustainability is the ability of the environment to support a defined level of environmental quality and natural resource extraction rates forever to mankind. Unnecessary disturbances to the environment should be avoided whenever possible to sustain our environment.

Students' Activity

(Teacher should get a record of the students)

* **Play outside!**

  This simple activity goes a long way in teaching sustainability. Sharing in and appreciating a love of the outdoors will inspire children to care for earth.

* **Read books about the earth.**

  Books are great for young children to begin to learn about the earth.

* **Make your own paper.**

  Kids can use recycled paper scraps to make new paper!

Why is sustainability important?

The excessive usage of natural and manmade resources deplete its availability for the future generation. We need to look after our planet, our resources and our people to ensure that we can hand over our planet to our children to live in true sustainability. Hence conservation and awareness are the two important terms that can bring sustainability to our living. When we use the word sustainability to mean maintain, it means to maintain it forever. This is because our actions have a lasting effect on the environment and we should protect it for our future generations.

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